ANCIENT INDIAN HISTORY REVISION NOTES

Indus Valley Civilization (IVC)

Harappan Culture

Nomenclature & Core Historiography: Known as the Indus Civilization, Indus Valley Civilization, and Harappan Civilization. **Sir John Marshall** was the first scholar to coin the term *"Indus Civilization"*. **Stuart Piggott** famously designated Harappa and Mohenjo-daro as the *"Twin Capitals of an Extensive Empire"*.

GEOGRAPHICAL EXTENT & CHRONOLOGY

Shape & Area: Triangular shape covering approximately **1.3 million sq. km**.
Carbon Dating (C-14): 2600 BCE – 1900 BCE (Mature Harappan peak). Contemporary with Bronze Age Mesopotamia and Egypt.

Racial Composition: Four primary anthropological groups identified:
1. Mediterranean (Dominant group at Mohenjo-daro)
2. Proto-Australoid (Caucasian) 3. Alpine 4. Mongoloid.

GEOGRAPHICAL EXTREMITIES (FRONTIER OUTPOSTS):

NORTHERN BOUNDARY	SOUTHERN BOUNDARY	WESTERN BOUNDARY	EASTERN BOUNDARY
Manda	**Daimabad**	**Sutkagen Dor**	**Alamgirpur**
J&K | Chenab River	Maharashtra | Pravara	Baluchistan | Dasht	Western UP | Hindon

PRINCIPAL URBAN CENTRES & MATERIAL FINDINGS

1. Harappa (First Discovered Site)

Left bank of Ravi | Sahiwal, Punjab (Pak)

- **Excavation:** Discovered in 1921 by Rai Bahadur Daya Ram Sahni under Sir John Marshall; expanded by M.S. Vats (1926) & Mortimer Wheeler (1946). Earliest notice was given by Charles Masson in 1826.
- **Town Layout:** Divided into an Eastern *"Town Mound"* and Western *"Citadel Mound"* (designated **Mound A-B** by Wheeler).
- **Granaries:** 12 distinct granary units arranged in two parallel rows of 6 rooms each.
- **Artefacts & Burial: Cemetery R-37** located south of Mound A-B; terracotta figurine of woman with plant emerging from womb (Goddess of Fertility/Earth); copper cart model; pot painted with fisherman scene.

2. Mohenjo-daro ("Mound of the Dead")

Right bank of Indus | Larkana, Sindh (Pak)

- **Excavation:** Discovered in 1922 by Rakhaldas Banerjee (R.D. Banerjee).
- **The Great Bath:** Overall complex: 55m (N-S) × 33m (E-W); Bath pool measures 39 ft (11.88m) long, 23 ft (7.01m) wide, and 8 ft (2.43m) deep. Termed by Marshall as an *"epichal architectural marvel"*.
- **Monuments:** Great Granary (150 ft × 75 ft), collegiate hall/priests' quarters, Western "Stupa Mound" (overlaying Kushan period stupa), central road 9.15m wide (Oxford Circus grid).
- **Famous Sculptures:** Bronze **Dancing Girl** (cire-perdue / lost-wax cast), steatite Bearded Priest, and **Pashupati Seal** (seated yogi flanked by tiger, elephant, rhino, buffalo, and 2 deer beneath seat).

SECONDARY URBAN SETTLEMENTS & DISTINCT ATTRIBUTES

Chanhudaro (Sindh)
N.G. Majumdar / E.J.H. Mackay

- Exclusive industrial center: **Bead-making factory** & shell work.
- Use of **curved bricks**; only major IVC site **without a fortified citadel**.
- Evidence of cosmetics (lipstick traces), toy cart, and dog pawprints chasing a cat. Later Jhukar & Jhangar culture phase.

Lothal (Gujarat)
Bhogava River | Dr. S.R. Rao

- World's earliest known **Tidal Dockyard** connected to Arabian Sea.
- Known as *"Micro-Harappa"*; circular Persian Gulf Seal discovered.
- Remains of rice (paddy) husks, ivory linear scale, and triple joint burials.

Kalibangan (Rajasthan)
Ghaggar | A. Ghosh / B.B. Lal

- Earliest **ploughed agricultural field** with cross-grid furrow marks.
- Earliest recorded evidence of an earthquake; 7 fire altars in a row; camel bones.

Dholavira (Gujarat)
Rann of Kutch | J.P. Joshi / R.S. Bisht

- Unique **tripartite division** (Citadel, Middle Town, Lower Town).
- Sophisticated **rock-cut water harvesting** & 10-character signboard inscription.

Quick Reference: *Rakhigarhi* (Haryana) is the largest Harappan site in India. *Surkotada* (Gujarat) yielded horse bone remains. *Ropar* (Punjab) revealed a human buried with a domestic dog. *Daimabad* yielded a heavy bronze chariot model.

RAW MATERIAL SOURCING & OVERSEAS TRADE

Raw Mineral	Primary Source Region	Commercial Mechanism
Copper	Khetri (Rajasthan), Baluchistan, Oman	• Monyless economy based strictly on **Barter exchange**. • Mesopotamian texts refer to Indus as **"Meluhha"**, Bahrain as **"Dilmun"** (the clean city of sunrise), and Makran as **"Magan"**. • Weight standards followed a cubical binary system.
Lapis Lazuli	Badakhshan (Afghanistan)	
Silver & Tin	Iran, Afghanistan (Silver also: Zawar & Ajmer)	
Gold & Lead	Gold: Kolar (Karnataka); Lead: Ajmer, Iran	

SOCIETY, RELIGION & THEORIES OF DECLINE

Socio-Religious Framework:
• Likely *Matriarchal* social order (predominance of female figurines).
• Worship of Mother Goddess, Proto-Shiva (Pashupati), Pipal tree, and Humped Bull.
• No temples erected; standard burial orientation: head pointed North, feet South.

Cause of Decline	Scholarly Proponents
Catastrophic Floods	Marshall, Mackay, S.R. Rao
Aryan Invasion	Wheeler, Gordon Childe, Piggott
Aridity / Climate Shift	Aurel Stein, A. Ghosh
Tectonic Alterations	M.R. Sahni, R.L. Raikes, Dales
Epidemic	K.U.R. Kennedy